

LAPTOPS DO EVERYTHING MACHINES



Getting the best value for your money

Yetnesh Dubey | yetnesh@digit.in

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ainstream laptops have turned into do-everything machines in recent years. Nowadays, we demand

high battery life, a more portable form factor, good iGPU or discrete GPU performance for light gaming, an above-average display, solid build quality, and more. You get the idea. As advancements in chip design continue, features once restricted to top-end devices are now available in the budget category. The biggest winner here is the end consumer.

For example, Intel's X86 Hybrid Architecture processors, introduced with its 12th gen lineup, have become really affordable in 2024. You can get a good mid-range Intel "H" series processor for under Rs 65,000 at the time of writing this article. And chances are, if you're reading this in the future, these chips are even more affordable.

Similarly, DDR5, the new standard of memory or RAM, is becoming mainstream, with the budget segment being the main beneficiary. In 2024, OLED laptop screens have become incredibly affordable, starting at just Rs 40,000. OLEDs are thinner and lighter than LCDs, providing better viewing angles and contributing to sleek, modern laptop designs. Now available in mid-range and budget models, OLED technology is more accessible than ever. Professionals and multimedia enthusiasts benefit from fast response

times and reduced motion blur, significantly enhancing their overall experience. This democratisation of OLED technology means high-quality displays are now paired with affordability and energy efficiency, making them a top choice for many.

Overall, the improvements in mainstream laptops over recent years are remarkable. We're now seeing devices that are versatile and powerful, capable of handling a wide range of tasks without breaking the bank. This evolution in technology has made advanced features more accessible, offering incredible value and performance to everyday users.

LOW-END (₹40,000 TO ₹50,000)

In this category, ideal specifications are:

- Processor - up to Intel Core i5 12th Gen (Excluding the high performance "H" series) and AMD Ryzen 7000 series CPUs (Excluding the HX series)
- RAM - Up to 16GB DDR4 or DDR5
- Storage - At least 512GB

Apart from the main specifications, features like display, size, weight, and build material can vary in budget mainstream laptops. For reference, you can easily find laptops in this price range with screen sizes between 14 to 16 inches. In terms of weight, almost all laptops will be under 2 kg, with most weighing between 1.4 to 1.6 kg.

Remember, we're looking for an all-rounder machine that fits a budget and

will last us at least 3 to 4 years. It should be capable of handling multimedia tasks, daily productivity tasks like browsing and streaming, and should be portable enough to carry around easily. Most likely, such a laptop won't have a dedicated GPU, especially if you're looking at a machine under Rs 40,000. However, if it does, that's a bonus. They will, however, definitely have an integrated GPU (iGPU).

If you opt for an APU, which stands for Accelerated Processing Unit and includes mainly the Ryzen 5000 to 7000 series processors, the chances of your laptop being capable of light gaming increase tremendously. APUs combine a CPU and a powerful iGPU, providing a good balance between performance and efficiency without significantly raising the cost. This makes them an excellent choice for budget-conscious buyers who still want decent graphics performance for tasks like light gaming or multimedia editing.

Additionally, the build materials of these laptops can vary. While more budget-friendly options might use polycarbonate, slightly higher-end models within the budget range can feature more premium materials like aluminium, enhancing durability and aesthetics. This variation in build quality can significantly affect the overall feel and longevity of the laptop.

Overall, when choosing a budget mainstream laptop, look for a balanced combination of display quality, size,